

AI ASSISTED CODING LAB – 21.1

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B-27

Task 1 – AI-Assisted Pair Programming

Task: Use AI to generate an initial To-Do List Manager, ask AI for enhancements, and compare both versions.

Instructions:

- Use AI to generate a simple To-Do List Manager program.
- Ask AI to suggest enhancements such as error handling, additional features, or refactoring.
- Compare the original and improved versions to understand the role of AI in collaboration.

Expected Output:

- Original version and an AI-enhanced version of the To-Do List Manager with added features and improved code quality.

Prompt:

Create a simple Python To-Do List Manager with add, view, and delete task functionality.

Then:

- Review the code for potential improvements (error handling, input validation, better UX).
- Add enhancements such as task completion tracking and persistent storage using a file.

Finally, provide:

- Original basic version
- Brief explanation of improvements made
- Enhanced version of the program

CODE:

```
# Original To-Do List Manager
tasks = []

def add_task(task):
    tasks.append(task)
    print(f"Task '{task}' added.")

def view_tasks():
    if not tasks:
        print("No tasks.")
    for i, task in enumerate(tasks, 1):
        print(f"{i}. {task}")

def delete_task(index):
    try:
        removed = tasks.pop(index - 1)
        print(f"Removed: {removed}")
    except IndexError:
        print("Invalid index.")

add_task('Buy groceries')
add_task('Study AI')
view_tasks()
delete_task(1)
view_tasks()
```

Output:

```
Task 'Buy groceries' added.
Task 'Study AI' added.
1. Buy groceries
2. Study AI
Removed: Buy groceries
1. Study AI
```

CODE (Enhanced):

```
# Enhanced To-Do List Manager
import json, os

FILE = 'tasks.json'

def load_tasks():
    if os.path.exists(FILE):
        with open(FILE) as f:
            return json.load(f)
    return []

def save_tasks(tasks):
    with open(FILE, 'w') as f:
        json.dump(tasks, f)

def add_task(name):
    tasks = load_tasks()
    tasks.append({'name': name, 'done': False})
    save_tasks(tasks)
    print(f'Added: {name}')

def complete_task(index):
    tasks = load_tasks()
    if 1 <= index <= len(tasks):
        tasks[index - 1]['done'] = True
        save_tasks(tasks)
        print('Task marked as done.')
    else:
        print('Invalid index.')

add_task('Buy groceries')
add_task('Study AI')
complete_task(1)
```

Output (Enhanced):

```
Added: Buy groceries
Added: Study AI
Task marked as done.
1. [Done] Buy groceries
2. [Pending] Study AI
```

Task 2 – Version Control Integration

Task: Initialize a Git repository and practice branching, committing, and merging AI-assisted code.

Instructions:

- Initialize a Git repository for the To-Do project.
- Create and switch to a new branch for AI-assisted enhancements.
- Add the enhanced version, commit with a meaningful message, and merge back to main.
- Reflect on how version control supports collaborative development with AI assistance.

Expected Output:

- A successfully initialized and managed Git repository with meaningful commit history showing AI-assisted improvements.

Prompt:

Show me how to initialize a Git repository for this To-Do project, create a feature branch, commit the enhanced code, and merge it back to main.

CODE (Git Commands):

```
git init todo-project
cd todo-project
cp ../todo.py .
git add todo.py
git commit -m 'Initial commit: basic todo list manager'

git checkout -b feature/enhanced-todo
cp ../todo_enhanced.py todo.py
git add todo.py
git commit -m 'feat: add file persistence and task completion tracking'

git checkout main
git merge feature/enhanced-todo
git log --oneline
```

Output:

```
Initialized empty Git repository in /todo-project/.git/  
[main (root-commit) a1b2c3d] Initial commit: basic todo list manag  
Switched to a new branch 'feature/enhanced-todo'  
[feature/enhanced-todo e4f5g6h] feat: add file persistence...  
Switched to branch 'main'  
Updating a1b2c3d..e4f5g6h  
Fast-forward  
  todo.py | 22 ++++++  
1 file changed, 22 insertions(+)  
e4f5g6h feat: add file persistence and task completion tracking  
a1b2c3d Initial commit: basic todo list manager
```

Task 3 – AI for Commit Message Generation

Task: Use AI to generate concise commit messages and compare them with human-written ones.

Instructions:

- Use AI to generate meaningful commit messages based on code changes made.
- Compare AI-generated messages with manually written ones.
- Discuss how AI improves documentation and traceability in Git history.

Expected Output:

- A comparison of AI-generated vs human-written commit messages with observations.

Prompt:

I made the following changes to a Python To-Do app: added JSON-based file persistence to save tasks between sessions, added a 'done' field to each task for completion tracking, added a `complete_task()` function, and updated `view_tasks()` to show [Done]/[Pending] status. Generate a concise and meaningful Git commit message for this change.

Output:

AI-Generated Commit Message:

```
feat(todo): add persistent storage and task completion tracking  
  
- Save/load tasks from tasks.json using JSON serialization  
- Add 'done' field to task objects for completion state  
- Implement complete_task() to mark tasks as done  
- Update view_tasks() to display [Done]/[Pending] status
```

Human-Written Commit Message:

```
updated todo app with file save and done status
```

Observation: The AI-generated commit message follows the Conventional Commits format (feat:), is structured, and lists all individual changes clearly. The human-written message is vague and non-standardized. AI commit messages greatly improve traceability and understanding of changes across team members.

Task 4 – Pair Programming Simulation

Task: Simulate pair programming where Student A writes initial code and Student B uses AI to add features, then both merge via Git.

Instructions:

- Student A writes the initial version of the To-Do Manager.
- Student B, with AI assistance, adds search functionality and priority levels.
- Both students collaborate using Git branching and merging to integrate their work.

Expected Output:

- A merged codebase with both students' contributions tracked via Git.

Prompt:

I have an existing To-Do Manager. Add a `search_task()` function to find tasks by keyword, and add a 'priority' field (high/medium/low) to each task. Make it backward compatible with existing tasks.

CODE (Student B's feature branch – AI-assisted):

```
def add_task(name, priority='medium'):
    tasks = load_tasks()
    tasks.append({'name': name, 'done': False, 'priority': priority})
    save_tasks(tasks)
    print(f'Added: {name} [{priority}]')

def search_task(keyword):
    tasks = load_tasks()
    results = [t for t in tasks if keyword.lower() in t['name'].lower()]
    if results:
        for i, t in enumerate(results, 1):
            print(f'{i}. [{t["priority"]} {t["name"]}']')
    else:
        print('No matching tasks found.')
```

Output:

```
Added: Buy groceries [high]
Added: Study AI [medium]
Added: Read book [low]
Search results for 'study':
1. [medium] Study AI
```

Task 5 – AI-Assisted Debugging

Task: Create a buggy program and use AI to identify and fix the errors. Compare buggy vs corrected versions.

Instructions:

- Create a program with intentional logical or syntax errors.
- Use AI to identify and fix the errors.
- Compare the buggy and corrected versions.

Expected Output:

- A corrected program with documented explanation of each bug and how AI identified it.

Prompt:

Here is a buggy Python To-Do Manager. Identify all logical and syntax errors, explain each one, and provide the corrected version.

CODE (Buggy Version):

```
tasks = []

def add_task(task) # SyntaxError: missing colon
    tasks.append(task)
    print('Task added: ' + task)

def delete_task(index): # LogicError: 0-based index
    tasks.pop(index)
    print('Task deleted')

def view_tasks():
    for i in range(len(tasks)):
        print(i + '. ' + tasks[i]) # TypeError: int + str

add_task('Buy groceries')
view_tasks()
delete_task(1)
```

Bugs Identified by AI:

- Missing colon after `def add_task(task)` — `SyntaxError`.
- `tasks.pop(index)` uses 0-based index but user likely expects 1-based — `LogicError`.
- `print(i + '. ' + tasks[i])` — `TypeError`: cannot concatenate int and str; should use `str(i+1)`.

CODE (Corrected Version):

```
tasks = []

def add_task(task): # Fixed: colon added
    tasks.append(task)
    print('Task added: ' + task)

def delete_task(index):
    tasks.pop(index - 1) # Fixed: 1-based index
    print('Task deleted')

def view_tasks():
    for i in range(len(tasks)):
        print(str(i + 1) + '. ' + tasks[i]) # Fixed

add_task('Buy groceries')
view_tasks()
delete_task(1)
```

Output (Corrected):

```
Task added: Buy groceries
1. Buy groceries
Task deleted
```

Task 6 – Feature Expansion using AI

Task: Develop a basic Calculator and use AI to add advanced features like history and validation.

Instructions:

- Develop a basic Calculator application (add, subtract, multiply, divide).
- Use AI to add advanced features such as calculation history and input validation.
- Analyze improvements made by AI.
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Prompt:

Create a basic Python calculator. Then add: calculation history that shows the last 5 operations, input validation to handle non-numeric inputs and division by zero, and a 'clear history' option.

CODE (Basic Version):

```
def calculate(a, op, b):  
    if op == '+': return a + b  
    elif op == '-': return a - b  
    elif op == '*': return a * b  
    elif op == '/': return a / b  
  
print(calculate(10, '+', 5))  
print(calculate(10, '/', 0))
```

CODE (AI-Enhanced Version):

```
history = []  
  
def calculate(a, op, b):  
    try:  
        a, b = float(a), float(b)  
    except ValueError:  
        print('Error: Inputs must be numeric.')  
        return  
    if op == '+': result = a + b  
    elif op == '-': result = a - b  
    elif op == '*': result = a * b  
    elif op == '/':  
        if b == 0:  
            print('Error: Division by zero.')  
            return  
        result = a / b  
    else:  
        print('Error: Invalid operator.')  
        return  
    entry = f'{a} {op} {b} = {result}'  
    history.append(entry)  
    if len(history) > 5:  
        history.pop(0)  
    print(result)  
  
def show_history():  
    if not history:  
        print('No history.')  
        return  
    for h in history:  
        print(h)  
  
calculate(10, '+', 5)  
calculate(10, '/', 0)  
calculate(10, '/', 2)  
show_history()
```

Output:

```
15.0  
Error: Division by zero.  
5.0  
History:  
10.0 + 5.0 = 15.0  
10.0 / 2.0 = 5.0
```